

How much of a salary hike are you looking for?

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Obviously, this is one of the most difficult questions to answer!

If you're honest and say, 'Double the current salary', you won't get the job. If you say, 'I am fine getting even the old salary', you might actually end up getting it! A safe answer is, 'The same as the industry average hike one gets while moving to a new job' (whatever that 'industry average' means!). If you've done enough analysis about the salary structure in the new company and know that you'll get more for the same level of experience and skill set, you can say: 'The same as the salary that a person with similar experience and skills will get in your company', and throw the ball back in the interviewer's court.

Why should we hire you?

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This is a question that every interviewer has, while interviewing a candidate. They want a justification for why they should select you. The interviewer just bounces this ball to you and checks how you give the reason for hiring you!

Tell them about your professional and personal strengths, relevant job experience, or academic background, your suitability for the current job requirements, etc., and give your view on why they should hire you. Bad answers: 'Because I am desperate for a job'; 'I have searched for jobs for more than a year and I didn't get any—you should help me!'

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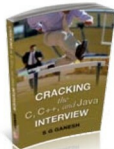
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Do you have any questions for us?

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Typically, an interviewer will ask this question just before the end of the interview. This is to check if you have any important questions that you want to get clarified. Instead of saying 'I have no questions', it is better to ask relevant questions to show your keen interest in getting the job.

Do show enthusiasm about the new job and ask about the new team, opportunities, company, etc. Good examples: 'What are the current problems that the team is facing now and how can I possibly help?', 'What are the career growth opportunities available in the company'. Bad examples: 'Did I do the interview well?', 'Will I get this job?' (Both are in the list of Frequently Asked Wrong Questions—never ask these questions in the interview! But yes, you can ask 'When can I expect to hear from you?')

**Cracking the C, C++, and Java Interview**

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